Kreps PR Crisis Communication Plan for Hedrick Brothers Construction

1. Purpose

The purpose of this crisis communication plan is to ensure rapid, transparent, and unified messaging to protect Hedrick Brothers Construction's reputation, maintain stakeholder trust, and ensure operational continuity during a crisis. This plan outlines protocols for managing crises such as construction accidents, environmental incidents, labor disputes, or public relations challenges, with specific roles for KrepsPR and Carrie Bailey, Senior Marketing Director.

2. Scope

This plan applies to all potential crises that could impact Hedrick Brothers Construction's operations, reputation, or stakeholder relationships. It covers internal and external communications, media relations, social media management, and post-crisis recovery strategies.

3. Crisis Definition

A crisis is any event that poses a significant risk to Hedrick Brothers Construction's reputation, operations, or stakeholders. Examples include:

- Construction site accidents (e.g., worker injuries or fatalities)
- Environmental incidents (e.g., spills or contamination)
- Financial issues (e.g., project delays or budget disputes)
- Personnel issues (e.g., labor strikes or misconduct)
- Social media backlash (e.g., negative reviews or viral complaints)

4. Crisis Communication Team

The crisis communication team will coordinate all responses and ensure consistent messaging. Key members include:

- **Carrie Bailey, Senior Marketing Director**: Oversees internal communications, serves as the primary liaison with KrepsPR, and ensures alignment between internal and external messaging.
- **KrepsPR (External PR Firm)**: Manages external communications, including media relations, press releases, and social media responses. KrepsPR will designate a lead crisis consultant to work directly with Hedrick Brothers Construction.

- **Dale Hedrick, CEO, or Designated Executive**: Acts as the primary spokesperson for high-level crises, delivering public statements or press conference remarks.
- **Patrick Painter, VP, Legal Counsel**: Reviews all communications to ensure legal compliance and mitigate liability risks.
- **Operations Manager**: Provides technical details about construction-related incidents to inform accurate messaging.
- **Lisa Hendricks, VP Talent and Culture, HR Representative**: Manages employee communications and addresses personnel-related crises.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Carrie Bailey**:
  - Communicates crisis details to internal stakeholders (employees, management) to ensure transparency and alignment.
  - Coordinates with KrepsPR to provide situational updates and approve messaging.
  - Monitors internal feedback and escalates concerns to the crisis team.
- **KrepsPR**:
  - Develops and disseminates external communications, including press releases, media statements, and social media posts.
  - Manages media inquiries, arranges press conferences, and conducts media training for spokespersons.
  - Monitors social media and news coverage to address misinformation and shape the narrative.
- **Dale Hedrick, CEO/Spokesperson**:
  - Delivers public statements or participates in media interviews, as advised by KrepsPR.
  - Represents the company's values and commitment to resolving the crisis.
- **Patrick Painter, Legal Counsel**:
  - Ensures all communications comply with legal and regulatory requirements.
  - Advises on potential liabilities and reputational risks.
- **Operations Manager**:
  - Provides factual details about construction incidents (e.g., cause of an accident, safety measures in place).
  - Collaborates with KrepsPR to ensure technical accuracy in messaging.
- **Lisa Hendricks, HR Representative**:
  - Addresses employee concerns and communicates crisis updates to staff.
  - Manages personnel-related issues, such as layoffs or misconduct allegations.

6. Media Training Protocols

Media training is critical to ensure that spokespersons (e.g., CEO, Carrie Bailey, or designated executives) communicate effectively during a crisis. KrepsPR will oversee media training with the following components:

- **Training Frequency**: Conduct semi-annual media training sessions for key spokespersons, with refreshers as needed before major projects or during heightened risk periods (e.g., hurricane season in Florida).
- **Training Content**:
    - **Message Development**: Craft clear, concise, and empathetic messages that align with Hedrick Brothers Construction's values (e.g., safety, quality, community).
    - **On-Camera Practice**: Simulate press conferences and interviews to build confidence and improve delivery.
    - **Handling Tough Questions**: Practice responding to difficult or hostile questions (e.g., "Why did this accident happen?") with transparency and accountability.
    - **Nonverbal Communication**: Train on body language, tone, and facial expressions to convey sincerity and control.
    - **Social Media Awareness**: Educate spokespersons on the impact of social media and the importance of avoiding, or mitigating, off-the-cuff remarks online.
- **Key Messages**:
    - Emphasize Hedrick Brothers Construction's commitment to safety, transparency, and community well-being.
    - Acknowledge the crisis, express concern for affected parties, and outline steps being taken to address the issue.
    - Avoid speculation or unverified information; defer to ongoing investigations when necessary.

7. Social Media Platforms

Social media is a critical channel for crisis communication, given its speed and reach. Hedrick Brothers Construction will use the following platforms, responses and actions managed by KrepsPR, in coordination with Carrie Bailey:

- **LinkedIn**:
    - **Purpose**: Communicate with professional stakeholders (clients, partners, industry peers) and reinforce the company's commitment to professionalism and accountability.
    - **Content**: Share official statements **as appropriate and agreed on from legal**, project updates, and recovery efforts to maintain trust among B2B audiences.

- **Twitter/X**:
    - **Purpose**: Provide real-time updates and address public concerns quickly **as appropriate**, given the platform's fast-paced nature.
    - **Content**: Post brief, factual updates **if necessary** (e.g., "We are investigating the incident and will provide updates soon") and respond to user comments to correct misinformation.
- **Facebook**:
    - **Purpose**: Engage with the local West Palm Beach community and broader public, who may follow the company for updates.
    - **Content**: Share detailed statements, community outreach efforts, and links to press releases for transparency as agreed on by crisis team.
- **Instagram**:
    - **Purpose**: Humanize the brand by showcasing community involvement and recovery efforts (e.g., photos of safety training or community support initiatives).
    - **Content**: Post visuals with captions that reinforce empathy and action, avoiding promotional content during a crisis. **As agreed on by crisis team**
- **Monitoring Tools**: Use appropriate software to monitor brand mentions, track sentiment, and identify misinformation across platforms.

8. Crisis Management Steps – "What to do" Timeline

The following steps outline the order and actions to be taken when a crisis occurs:

Step 1: Assess the Situation (0-2 Hours)

- **Action**: The crisis communication team, led by Carrie Bailey, convenes to evaluate the crisis (e.g., a construction site accident). Carrie Bailey notifies all crisis team members and assigns roles.
- **Tasks**:
    - Gather facts from the Operations Manager (e.g., what happened, who was affected, immediate actions taken).
    - Consult Legal Counsel to identify potential liabilities.
    - KrepsPR conducts an initial media and social media scan to gauge public reaction.
- **Output**: A situation brief created by crisis team summarizing the crisis, known facts, and potential impacts.

Step 2: Activate the Crisis Team (2-4 Hours)

- **Action**: Clear communication by email or project management platform
- **Tasks**:
  - Legal Counsel reviews initial messaging for compliance.
  - KrepsPR designates a lead consultant to manage external communications.
  - Carrie Bailey informs employees via email or internal memo, emphasizing transparency and directing them to avoid public comments.
- **Output**: A unified crisis response structure with clear roles and communication channels.

Step 3: Develop Initial Messaging (4-6 Hours)

- **Action**: KrepsPR drafts a holding statement for immediate release, approved by Carrie Bailey and Legal Counsel.
- **Tasks**:
  - Post the approved statement on Twitter/X, LinkedIn, and Facebook, with a link to the company website for further details.
  - Prepare the Dale Hedrick, CEO, or other designated spokesperson for potential media inquiries, using media training protocols.
  - Kreps PR team to manage and participate in all press interviews to mitigate misinformation.
- **Output**: A public holding statement and internal memo to employees.

Step 4: Engage with Media and Stakeholders (6-24 Hours)

- **Action**: Kreps PR manages media inquiries and stakeholder communications, with Carrie Bailey coordinating internal updates.
- **Tasks**:
  - Kreps PR arranges a press conference if needed or issues a detailed press release if the crisis is severe (e.g., a fatality).
  - Respond to media inquiries with factual, approved statements, avoiding speculation.
  - Carrie Bailey communicates with employees, clients, and community partners, emphasizing the company's commitment to resolution.
  - Monitor social media for misinformation and respond with clarifications (e.g., "We can confirm that safety protocols were in place; we are cooperating with authorities.").
- **Output**: Press release, media responses, and stakeholder communications.

Step 5: Implement Ongoing Communication (24 Hours–1 Week)

- **Action**: KrepsPR and Carrie Bailey provide regular updates as new information emerges.
- **Tasks**:
  - Post daily updates on social media platforms, focusing on progress (e.g., "We have completed an initial safety review and are implementing additional measures.").
  - KrepsPR manages follow-up media inquiries and coordinates interviews with the CEO or spokesperson.
  - Carrie Bailey holds internal briefings to keep employees informed and address concerns.
  - Use Instagram to share visuals of recovery efforts (e.g., community support or safety training).
- **Output**: Regular social media posts, media updates, and internal communications.

Step 6: Post-Crisis Recovery (1 Week–1 Month)

- **Action**: The crisis team evaluates the response and implements reputation recovery strategies.
- **Tasks**:
  - Conduct a debrief with KrepsPR and Carrie Bailey to identify lessons learned and update the crisis plan.
  - KrepsPR develops a reputation recovery plan, including community outreach and positive media stories.
  - Carrie Bailey communicates long-term actions to employees (e.g., enhanced safety training).
  - Monitor social media and news for lingering negative sentiment, addressing it with proactive messaging.
- **Output**: A revised crisis plan, community engagement initiatives, and positive PR campaigns.

9. Metrics for Success

To evaluate the effectiveness of the crisis response, track the following metrics:

- **Response Time**: Time from crisis onset to first public statement (target: within 6 hours).
- **Media Sentiment**: Percentage of neutral or positive media coverage within 1 week (target: 70%+).
- **Social Media Engagement**: Reduction in negative comments and increase in supportive posts (target: 30% reduction in negative sentiment).

- **Stakeholder Trust**: Employee and client feedback via surveys post-crisis (target: 80%+ satisfaction with communication).

10. Pre-Crisis Preparation

To ensure readiness, Hedrick Brothers Construction will:

- Conduct quarterly crisis simulations with KrepsPR to test the plan and train the team.
- Maintain a media contact list, updated by KrepsPR, with local (e.g., Palm Beach Post) and national outlets (e.g., Construction Dive).
- Develop pre-approved holding statements for common scenarios (e.g., accidents, delays).
- Monitor social media regularly using Hootsuite (or another tool) to detect early warning signs.

11. Contact Information

- **Carrie Bailey, Senior Marketing Director**: cbailey@hedrickbrothers.com 561-943-6446
- **KrepsPR Lead Consultant**: Kristen Noffsinger knoffsinger@krepspr.com 954-464-7388
- **Internal Crisis Hotline**: number? info@hedrickbrothers.com press@hedrickbrothers.com

12. Conclusion

This crisis communication plan equips Hedrick Brothers Construction to respond swiftly and effectively to crises, with clear roles for Carrie Bailey and KrepsPR. By prioritizing transparency, media training, and strategic social media use, the company can protect its reputation and maintain trust with stakeholders in West Palm Beach and key geographic market areas.

Social Platform Access Usernames + Passwords

- Facebook – Admins –
- Instagram – permission authority
- LinkedIn -
- X -
- YouTube -
- Website -